

Shuning Li

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics

Department of Economics, Western University

sli2744@uwo.ca — +1-647-891-9629

Research Interests

Labor Economics; Applied Microeconometrics; Family Economics

Education

Ph.D. in Economics , Western University, London, ON 2022–present

- Job market paper: *Child Penalties and the Reallocation of Mothers' Career Paths*

M.A. in Economics (with honors) , Nanjing University, Nanjing, China 2019–2021

- GPA: 92/100, Rank: 1/7
- Thesis: *Trade Barriers and Overcapacity: Evidence from the Tariff War between China and the US* (Best Research Master's Thesis in Jiangsu Province)

B.A. in Economics (with honors) , Sun Yat-sen University, Guangzhou, China 2015–2019

- GPA: 90/100, Rank: 6/33
- Thesis: *Does Business Start-up Reform Increase Market Entry?* (High Distinction, Top 5%)
- Top Graduate of Lingnan College, Valedictorian of Class 2019

Publications

“**Vertical Structure, Managerial Delegation, and the Choice of Capacity**”, with Jiancai Pi. *Journal of Central University of Finance & Economics*, Jan 2022, pp. 89–98.

“**Vertical Structure and Wage Inequality**”, with Jiancai Pi and Shumin Yu. *International Journal of Economic Theory*, 2026, 22(2), pp. 161–182.

“**Managerial Delegation and Wage Inequality**”, with Jiancai Pi. *Annals of Economics and Finance*, 2022, 23(1), pp. 141–157.

Working Papers

“**Marriage Squeeze and Education Choice: Evidence from China's Imbalanced Sex Ratios**”. *Memo*, May 2025.

Presented at the Canadian Economics Association Annual Conference (CEA), Simon Fraser University, Vancouver, May 2026.

“**Child Penalties and the Reallocation of Mothers' Career Paths**”.

Research Experience

Research Assistant – Prof. Lance Lochner, Western University 2024–present
Conducted data analysis and visualizations in Stata; estimated composite investment prices for ongoing research

Research Assistant – Prof. Audra Bowlus, Western University 2025–present
Conducted analysis on human capital and wage growth using LISA data

Jiangsu Province “333” Project: Institutional Overcapacity 2020–2021
Developed sequential game models and applied stochastic frontier analysis to study trade barriers and capacity utilization; results incorporated into Master’s thesis and journal publication.

National Social Science Fund Project: Business System Reform 2018–2019
Field surveys across 16 provinces; managed data group; built Stata database; results cited in reform assessments. Undergraduate thesis based on this project awarded Excellent Thesis (Top 5%).

Teaching Experience

Western University, Teaching Assistant 2022–present

- PhD courses: Macroeconomics, Economic Mathematics
- Master courses: Macroeconomic Theory for Finance, Microeconomic Theory for Finance
- Undergraduate courses: Principles of Macroeconomics, Econometrics

Honors and Awards

Center for Human Capital and Productivity (CHCP) Graduate Fellowship (2026)

The Gervan Fearon PhD Award (2026)

Ph.D. Scholarship, Western University (2022–2025)

Best Research Master’s Thesis in Jiangsu Province (2023)

First-class Student Scholarship, Nanjing University (2019–2022, Top 1%)

Honored Graduate, Nanjing University (2021)

First Prize, Challenge Cup National College Student Contest (2021)

“Survey China” Top 15, South Reviews (2020)

Honored Graduate, Sun Yat-sen University (2019)

Top Graduate of Lingnan College, Sun Yat-sen University (2019)

Excellent Undergraduate Thesis, Sun Yat-sen University (2019, Top 1%)

First-class Student Scholarship, Sun Yat-sen University (2017, 2018)

Hongxin Scholarship (2018); International Exchange Scholarship (2017)

Xinhua Insurance Scholarship (2016)

Skills

Programming: Stata, R, Matlab, Mathematica, L^AT_EX, Julia

Languages: Mandarin (native), English (fluent)

Last updated: September 10, 2026